# THE FLOSS RULE

**Name:** ..... **Date:** .....

Read the rule, work through the three checks on the example, then finish the six words. Write one letter in each dashed box.

## THE FLOSS RULE

| ff | ll | ss | zz |
|---|---|---|---|
| cliff | bell | grass | buzz |

In a one-syllable word with one short vowel, the **f, l, s or z** at the end is doubled. The word **floss** is the reminder: it holds the letters f, l and s, and it doubles its own s. The letter z does the same thing in buzz and fizz, so it joins the list.

**WORKED EXAMPLE: BE__ → BELL**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **One syllable?** | Clap it: bell. One clap, so yes. |
| 2 | **One vowel, saying its short sound?** | The e in bell says /e/ as in egg. Yes. |
| 3 | **Ends in f, l, s or z?** | It ends in l, so double the l: be + l + l = bell. |

1. **cli** ☐☐ a steep wall of rock

2. **gra** ☐☐ green, and you mow it

3. **pu** ☐☐ a short blow of air

4. **mi** ☐☐ it grinds wheat into flour

5. **bu** ☐☐ the sound a bee makes

6. **dre** ☐☐ you can wear it

All three checks have to pass. Longer words such as pencil and until keep a single l. The rule also stops when another letter gets in the way: in self, shelf and golf the last letter comes after a second consonant, and in roof, cool and feel the vowel is long, so nothing doubles.


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# THE FLOSS RULE ANSWER KEY

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2. gra **s** **s** green, and you mow it

3. pu **f** **f** a short blow of air

4. mi **l** **l** it grinds wheat into flour

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